

Strings and lists

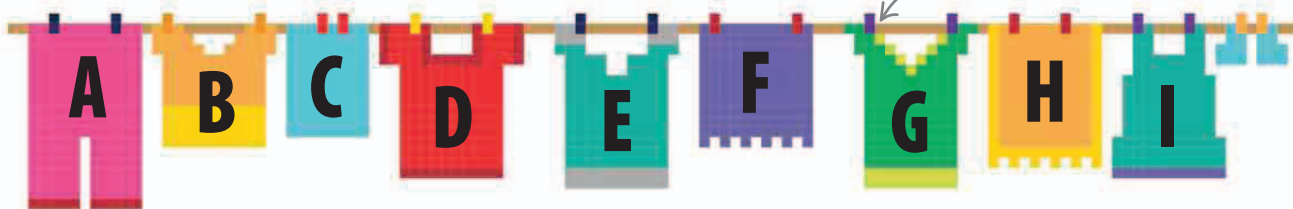
In programming, a sequence of letters and symbols is called a “string”. Strings can contain any character on the keyboard (including spaces) and be of any length. Strings can also be grouped together in lists.

SEE ALSO

◀ 50–51 Variables

Strings 114–115 ▶
in Python

Keyboard characters are lined up as if they were hanging from a string

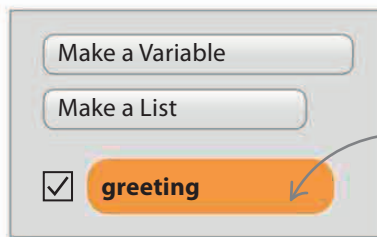


Working with words

Programs often need to remember words, such as a player’s name. Variables can be created to remember these words. Scratch programs can also ask the user questions, which they answer by typing into a text box that pops up. The following script asks for the user’s name, and then makes a sprite say “Hello” to them.

1 Create a new variable

Click the “Data” button in the blocks palette and click the “Make a Variable” button. Create a variable called “greeting”.

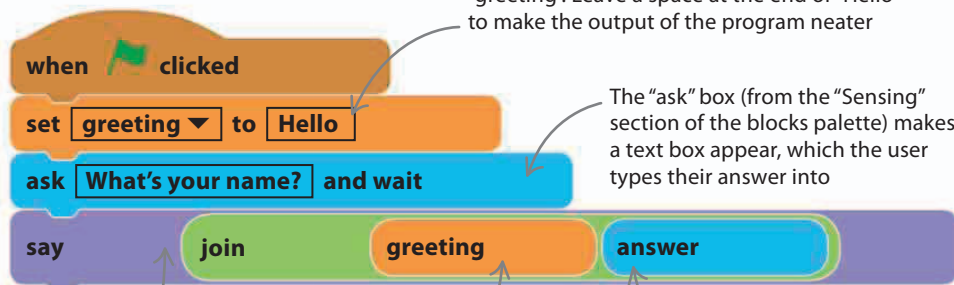


Name your variable “greeting”

This block puts “Hello ” into the variable “greeting”. Leave a space at the end of “Hello ” to make the output of the program neater

2 Asking a question

This script makes the sprite ask a question. Whatever the user types into the text box that pops up on the screen is stored in a new variable called “answer”. The script then combines the strings contained in the “greeting” and “answer” variables to greet to the user.



The “say” bubble creates a speech bubble for the sprite

The “greeting” variable holds the string “Hello ”

The “ask” box (from the “Sensing” section of the blocks palette) makes a text box appear, which the user types their answer into

The “answer” variable (from the “Sensing” section) contains whatever the user typed into the text box